

MORNING BRIEFING — SUNDAY 27 SEPTEMBER 2026

Generated 27 September 2026, ahead of Monday 28 September European open • Reference timezone: Europe/London (BST, UTC+1) • Data collected via open web sources during this session; last confirmed trading session is Friday 25 September 2026 (markets closed Saturday/Sunday) • Exact collection time per data point noted where available

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

Trump rejects Iran's proposal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz within seven days

[NPR / Al Jazeera](#) • [Saturday 26 September](#)

Iran's foreign minister offered a seven-day reopening plan including nuclear-inspector access, a new concession. Trump called the offer not "acceptable." The Strait has been effectively closed to commercial traffic since the war broke out on 28 February 2026 (1 transit recorded on 20 September vs. an 85/day pre-crisis baseline). Keeps Brent's geopolitical risk premium alive into Monday's open despite Friday's oil pullback.

Fed hiked rates 25bp to 3.75-4.00% on 16 September, first increase since 2023, dot plot signals more to come

[CNBC](#) • [week of 16 September, still driving repricing into this week](#)

FOMC voted 12-0. Of 18 officials, 16 project at least one further hike in 2026 (12 see exactly one more, 4 see two more). 10-year UST spiked toward 4.68% on the decision and has continued higher since, reaching 5.17% by Friday's close. Sets the tone for this week's NFP and eurozone inflation data.

German Bund 10-year yield at highest since mid-2009 (~3.58%)

[Trading Economics](#) • [25 September close](#)

Follows the ECB's own 25bp hike (deposit rate to 2.50%) on 16 September, delivered alongside warnings of higher energy-driven inflation. European natural gas is up roughly 100% since late June to three-year highs, feeding the inflation trajectory the ECB is now defending against.

Oil fell Friday on hopes of Mideast progress, even as the Hormuz standoff continues

[Market wrap coverage \(STL.News, EnergyNow\)](#) • [Friday 25 September close](#)

Brent settled at \$104.32 (-2.14%), WTI at \$92.41 (-2.33%), pulling back from the week's highs. Saudi Arabia's crude exports hit ~6mb/d in September, the highest since the war began, partly offsetting the Hormuz disruption. Tanker day-rates remain above \$1m for Gulf-transiting vessels.

Wall Street closed the week higher: S&P 500 +0.51%, Dow +0.93%, Nasdaq +0.5%

[CNBC / Yahoo Finance](#) • [Friday 25 September close](#)

Stabilising Treasury yields, falling oil and resilient durable-goods/core-capex data (core capital goods orders +1.6% in August) supported the Friday rally, described as driven by "fresh tech optimism." Sets a constructive baseline heading into Monday, contingent on the weekend's Hormuz headlines not reversing the oil move.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN)

CONTRACT	LEVEL	EXPECTED MOVE	COLLECTION TIME
Euro Stoxx 50 futures	n/a	n/a	—
DAX futures	n/a	n/a	—
CAC 40 futures	n/a	n/a	—
FTSE 100 futures	n/a	n/a	—
US futures — for context			
S&P 500 e-mini	n/a	n/a	—
Nasdaq 100 e-mini	n/a	n/a	—

This briefing was generated Sunday, before European and US index futures were quoted for Monday's session and before Asia's Monday cash open — no reliable pre-open levels exist yet in open sources. Directional bias to watch at the real pre-open: Trump's rejection of Iran's Hormuz reopening offer is a modest negative for risk/positive for oil, working against Friday's constructive close on Wall Street. Check CNBC/Bloomberg pre-market shortly before 07:00 BST for confirmed levels.

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — EUROPEAN INDICES (FRIDAY 25 SEPTEMBER 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
Euro Stoxx 50	n/a	n/a
DAX 40	25,408.64	+0.56%
CAC 40	8,077.80	−0.04%
FTSE 100	10,695.25	+0.14%

STOXX Europe 600 gained roughly 0.5% on the week, snapping a three-week losing streak, on relief from falling oil offset by pressure from rising bond yields. CAC 40 was the laggard, essentially flat, while DAX and FTSE 100 edged higher. Euro Stoxx 50's exact Friday close was not confirmed via public sources this session.

5. US MARKETS — YESTERDAY'S SESSION (FRIDAY 25 SEPTEMBER 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,743.41	+0.51%
Dow Jones Industrial Average	51,828.62	+0.93% (+478.64 pts)
Nasdaq Composite	27,068.72	+0.5%

U.S. equities closed a volatile week higher as Treasury yields stabilised, oil fell on Mideast de-escalation hopes, and August durable goods data confirmed resilient business investment (core capital goods orders +1.6% MoM). Yahoo Finance attributed the Friday advance partly to "fresh tech optimism." Sector leaders/laggards for the session were not broken out in detail in today's sources; oil-sensitive energy names likely lagged given the Brent/WTI pullback. Key takeaway: risk appetite held up even after the 16 September Fed hike, but the bond market has not stopped moving — 10-year yields are near cycle highs.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — LAST SESSION (FRIDAY 25 SEPTEMBER 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
Nikkei 225	66,364.20	+1.30% (+850.21 pts)
Hang Seng	24,510.09	-1.0% (-251.04 pts)
Shanghai Composite	n/a — market closed	—
Kospi	n/a — market closed	—

Nikkei extended its winning streak to five straight sessions on Friday, while Hang Seng fell for a third straight day. Mainland China and South Korea were both closed for holiday on Friday; Monday's reopening carries catch-up risk in both directions. This briefing predates Monday's actual Asian session (which runs ahead of European hours) — no confirmed levels exist yet for the 28 September session in open sources at time of writing.

7. COMMODITIES

COMMODITY	LEVEL	CHANGE	COLLECTION TIME
Brent (ICE, USD/bbl)	104.32	−2.14%	Fri 25 Sep close
WTI (NYMEX, USD/bbl)	92.41	−2.33%	Fri 25 Sep close
Gold (XAU/USD, USD/oz)	4,285	+0.24%	Fri 25 Sep
Copper (COMEX, USD/lb)	6.70	−0.35%	Fri 25 Sep
Natural gas (Henry Hub, USD/MMBtu)	n/a	n/a	—
Natural gas (TTF, EUR/MWh)	n/a	n/a	—

Both oil benchmarks fell Friday on hopes of Mideast progress, even though Trump has since rejected Iran's Hormuz reopening offer — a potential reversal risk into Monday. Gold sits near \$4,285 after retreating roughly 6.7% over the past month from its highs, still up ~13.7% year-on-year, as hawkish Fed/ECB repricing dulls the safe-haven bid. Copper has pulled back with gold and silver this month as rate-hike odds rose and the White House's copper tariff plan reportedly stalled, though it remains up over 14% year-to-date on tight mine supply (Chile, Indonesia and DRC output all down). European TTF gas is not directly quoted here but is reported up roughly 100% since late June to three-year highs, a live input to the ECB's inflation concerns.

8. RATES & FX

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	COLLECTION TIME
US 10-year Treasury	5.17%	−4bp on the day	Fri 25 Sep close
German 10-year Bund	~3.58%	Highest since mid-2009	Fri 25 Sep
EUR/USD	1.1387	+0.10%	Fri 25 Sep
GBP/USD	1.3247	+0.21%	Fri 25 Sep
DXY (Dollar Index)	101.03	−0.25%	Fri 25 Sep

The 10-year UST eased 4bp on Friday but remains dramatically higher than the ~4.68% seen right after the 16 September Fed hike — the curve has continued repricing the hawkish dot plot for over a week. Bund yields are at a 16-year high (~3.58%) as the ECB's own hike and surging gas prices feed European inflation expectations. EUR/USD and GBP/USD both firmed modestly Friday, though other sources flag the euro softening into the weekend (1.1382 on Saturday) on the broader hawkish-Fed dollar bid; DXY was tracking toward a second consecutive weekly gain per some commentary even as Friday's print eased. Watch this week's flash eurozone HICP and US NFP for the next leg.

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

RECENT NOTABLE ISSUANCE

ISSUER	CURRENCY	SIZE	TYPE	SPREAD / COUPON	NOTES
Banca Monte dei Paschi di Siena	EUR	€750m	Covered bond	30bp (vs 37bp IPT)	Tightest print since the bank's covered bond programme launched; attracted €2.4bn of orders (3.2x subscribed). Priced week of 22 September — exact Friday 25 September pricings (corporate IG/HY/SSA/financials) were not confirmed via public sources this session.
Amazon, Uber + 4 other US issuers	EUR / GBP	n/a	Corporate IG (US issuers, European market)	n/a	Priced 9 September — the largest single-day count of US corporate issuers in European markets on record; Amazon's sterling debut, Uber's euro debut. Reflects US corporates tapping European liquidity as domestic markets absorb AI-capex debt.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED THIS WEEK

No specific mandated EUR deals for the week of 28 September were identified via public sources this session. Context: five major US hyperscalers (Alphabet, Amazon, Meta, Microsoft, Oracle) now hold roughly €40bn of euro-denominated bonds between them, and the ECB has flagged concern that continued US hyperscaler issuance could crowd out European corporate borrowers and add upward pressure on regional spreads — a live risk factor for this week's window.

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LEVEL	MOVE / DIRECTION
iTraxx Europe Main 5y	n/a	WIDENING BIAS INTO SEP ROLL (EST. +5.7BP)
iTraxx Europe Crossover 5y	n/a	WIDENING BIAS INTO SEP ROLL (EST. +20.6BP)
CDX IG 5y (USD)	n/a	WIDENING BIAS INTO SEP ROLL (EST. +8.1BP)
Avg euro corporate IG spread	n/a	Reported "widened in recent days," particularly for the most indebted issuers

Exact current index levels require Bloomberg/ICE/Markit access; figures above are Barclays' September-roll fair-value estimates, not live quotes. iTraxx Main currently trades ~2bp wide of CDX IG in the outgoing series.

COMMENTARY

The primary window is selectively open rather than fully clear: MPS's covered bond print at the tightest level of its programme shows genuine investor demand for well-rated paper, but broader index positioning (the roll estimates above) points to a widening bias across Main, Crossover and CDX IG as the market digests a second straight month of central-bank hikes (Fed to 3.75–4.00%, ECB deposit to 2.50%) and a 16-year-high Bund yield. Funding conditions for industrials, transport and energy issuers remain serviceable given still-solid order books (e.g. European defense backlogs at records) and elevated commodity-linked cash flows, but the persistent surge in US hyperscaler EUR/GBP supply is a growing overhang the ECB itself has now flagged publicly.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR — WEEK OF 28 SEPTEMBER-2 OCTOBER 2026

DAY	ZONE	INDICATOR	CONSENSUS	IMPORTANCE
Mon–Wed	Eurozone (national)	Flash CPI — Germany, France, Italy, Spain	n/a per-country cons.	HIGH
Wed 1 Oct (approx.)	Eurozone	Flash HICP inflation (YoY)	3.5% YoY (core 2.6%)	HIGH
This week	Eurozone	Unemployment rate	6.4% (3rd month running)	MEDIUM
This week	Germany	Unemployment rate	6.4% (highest since 2020)	MEDIUM
This week	UK	Q2 GDP (final), business investment, BoE mortgage data	n/a	MEDIUM
Tue 30 Sep	US	JOLTS job openings (Aug)	7.23m (vs 7.27m prior)	MEDIUM
Wed 1 Oct	US	ADP private payrolls (Sep)	+70k	MEDIUM
Fri 2 Oct, 13:30 BST	US	Non-farm payrolls (Sep) & unemployment rate	+100k jobs (vs +162k Aug); unemployment 4.2% (vs 4.1%)	HIGH

The week's decisive print is Friday's NFP: a sub-100k reading alongside a rise in unemployment to 4.2% would reinforce the case for the Fed to pause after September's hike; a strong beat would validate the dot plot's call for further tightening. On the European side, flash HICP accelerating toward 3.5% YoY (highest since September 2023) would harden the ECB's hawkish tilt just as Bund yields sit at 16-year highs. Precise release times for the country-level flash CPIs were not confirmed this session; consult the exchange calendar nearer the print.

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS

COMPANY	MARKET	EVENT	TIMING
Carnival (CCL)	NYSE	Q3 FY2026 earnings, before market open	Mon 29 Sep
Jefferies Financial Group (JEF)	NYSE	Earnings	Mon 29 Sep
Paychex (PAYX)	Nasdaq	Earnings	Tue 30 Sep
Nike (NKE)	NYSE	Q1 FY2027 earnings, after close (cons. EPS \$0.27, revenue \$10.96bn)	Tue 30 Sep
Lamb Weston (LW)	NYSE	Earnings	Tue 30 Sep
Micron Technology (MU)	Nasdaq	Q4 FY2026 earnings, after close — HBM/server DRAM demand in focus, beat streak of 8/8 quarters	Tue 30 Sep
Conagra Brands (CAG)	NYSE	Earnings	Wed 1 Oct

No major European large-cap earnings or AGMs were identified for this week in public sources. Accenture's Q4 FY2026 report is due "late September" per available previews but a confirmed date within this specific week was not verified — flagged as a watch item regardless, given it already guided FY2026 revenue growth down to 3-4% (from 3-5%) on signs of slowing US client spend, with the stock down 34% YTD.

12. STOCKS TO WATCH

BP (BP.L) — LSE	JPMorgan upgraded to Overweight from Neutral, price target raised to 675p from 550p, in a sector reshuffle that used TotalEnergies as the funding source. Buoyed by the Bumerangue discovery offshore Brazil (~8bn boe), its largest find in 25 years.	Bullish
TotalEnergies (TTE.PA) — CAC 40	JPMorgan downgraded to Neutral (used as funding source for the BP upgrade) even as HSBC raised its target to €93 from €80, arguing its valuation premium to Shell has closed. Conflicting analyst calls make it a name to watch for dispersion.	Mixed / watch
Rheinmetall (RHM.DE) — DAX	Record order backlog of €80.4bn on European rearmament; sector order books up 15% and combined free cash flow at a record above €8bn. Potential EU push toward 3%-of-GDP defense spending is a further multi-year tailwind.	Bullish (structural)
UBS (UBSG.SW) — SIX	Was the biggest single-day decliner among European banks earlier this month (−4.2%) as the bond selloff hit financials. Watch for stabilisation or further pressure as Bund yields sit at 16-year highs.	Volatile / watch
Delta / American / United (DAL, AAL, UAL) — US majors	Airlines remain squeezed by oil above \$90–100/bbl and the Hormuz standoff, though United's CEO says the airline expects to recover 100% of higher fuel costs by Q4 via fares, with demand "very strong across the board." Trump's rejection of Iran's reopening offer is a fresh headwind for the group into Monday.	Bearish near-term
Tanker / shipping sector (crude tankers, Breakwave Tanker Shipping ETF — BWET)	Crude-tanker equities are up roughly 120% YTD, the broader Lloyd's List shipping basket +68% YTD, on Hormuz-driven freight and insurance spikes (day rates above \$1m for Gulf-transiting vessels). A durable-closure scenario after Trump's rejection of Iran's offer keeps the trade intact; any surprise reopening would be a sharp reversal risk.	Bullish, but crowded / binary risk
Freeport-McMoRan (FCX) / Rio Tinto (RIO) — copper miners	Copper still up >14% YTD on tight mine supply (Chile, Indonesia, DRC output all down), but pulled back this month with gold/silver on rate-hike odds and a stalled US copper-tariff plan. Sensitive to this week's Fed-path data (NFP) and any tariff headlines.	Watch / volatile
Nike (NKE) — NYSE	Reports Q1 FY2027 after close Tuesday. Shares near a 12-year low heading into the print, with tariff-cost pressure not expected to stabilise before mid-FY2027. Cons. EPS \$0.27, revenue \$10.96bn.	Binary event risk
Micron Technology (MU) — Nasdaq	Reports Q4 FY2026 after close Tuesday. Consensus looks for continued strong HBM/server-DRAM demand; the stock has beaten in each of its last 8 quarters. A read-through for European semi-equipment names (ASML, BESI) if it beats again.	Bullish setup

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

Fed hiked to 3.75–4.00%: First hike since 2023, 12-0 vote, hawkish dot plot (16 of 18 officials see at least one more 2026 hike). 10-year UST has moved from ~4.68% right after the decision to 5.17% by 25 September.

ECB hiked in parallel: Deposit rate to 2.50% on 16 September, alongside warnings on energy-driven inflation. Bund 10y at ~3.58%, highest since mid-2009.

Eurozone inflation re-accelerating: Flash HICP this week seen at 3.5% YoY (highest since September 2023), core at 2.6%. Unemployment steady at 6.4% in both the eurozone and Germany (a 2020-era high for Germany).

US labor market cooling gradually: September NFP consensus +100k (down from +162k in August), unemployment seen ticking up to 4.2%; JOLTS openings forecast to slip to 7.23m.

CORPORATE

US hyperscaler debt wave hits Europe: Amazon (sterling debut) and Uber (euro debut) led a record single-day count of US corporate issuers in European bond markets on 9 September; five hyperscalers now hold ~€40bn in euro bonds, prompting explicit ECB concern about crowding out European borrowers.

Oil majors re-rated: JPMorgan's new Overweight list is Shell, BP, Eni and Galp, funded by a TotalEnergies downgrade; HSBC meanwhile lifted TotalEnergies' target, arguing its valuation discount to Shell has closed. BP's Bumerangue find (Brazil, ~8bn boe) is its largest in 25 years.

European defense order books at records: Rheinmetall's backlog reached €80.4bn; combined free cash flow across Europe's top eight defense names hit a record above €8bn, with a possible move toward 3%-of-GDP NATO spending targets a further multi-year catalyst.

Tech/AI earnings loom: Micron, Nike and Accenture headline next week's US reporting slate; Accenture already cut FY2026 revenue growth guidance to 3–4% on slowing US client spend (stock down 34% YTD).

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

Hormuz standoff continues into an eighth month: Trump rejected Iran's latest reopening offer (which included nuclear-inspector access) as unacceptable. Strait transits remain down more than 80% from the pre-crisis baseline (1 recorded on 20 September vs. 85/day pre-war). War began 28 February 2026; a ceasefire (April) and MOU (June) both broke down by July.

Saudi Arabia filling the gap: Riyadh's crude exports hit ~6mb/d in September, the highest since the war began, despite continued Iran-backed militant attacks — a key reason Brent has not spiked further despite the closed Strait.

Shipping cost shock persists: Tanker day-rates above \$1m for Gulf-transiting vessels; war-risk insurance premiums have surged repeatedly since July as both Hormuz and Bab al-Mandeb remain effectively shut to normal traffic.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5

1. Trump rejects Iran's Hormuz offer

A fresh negative for oil-sensitive risk sentiment right as European futures open Monday; reverses some of Friday's oil-driven relief.

2. Post-Fed yield repricing still live

10-year UST at 5.17%, Bund at a 16-year high; any early-week move in either sets the tone for equity risk appetite.

3. China/Korea reopen after holiday closures

Shanghai Composite and Kospi were shut Friday; Monday's catch-up move (either direction) is a swing factor into the European open.

4. Flash eurozone inflation prints begin

National CPI releases through the week build toward Wednesday's eurozone-wide flash HICP, seen accelerating to 3.5% YoY.

5. Earnings pre-season: Nike, Micron, Accenture

First significant US corporate reads of the week land Tuesday, testing the "resilient consumer, strong AI capex" narrative.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

1. US September Non-Farm Payrolls (Friday)

Consensus +100k vs +162k in August; the key data point for whether the Fed pauses or delivers another 2026 hike per its dot plot.

2. Eurozone flash HICP

Seen at 3.5% YoY, core 2.6% — would be the highest headline print since September 2023 and could harden the ECB's hawkish tilt.

3. Nike / Micron / Accenture earnings

Consumer discretionary, memory/AI-chip demand and enterprise IT spend all get a read this week via three very different bellwethers.

4. Hormuz: any escalation or concession

Trump's rejection keeps the Strait shut; a surprise breakthrough (or new attack) would move oil and shipping equities sharply either way.

5. European primary bond supply test

Market must absorb further issuance against a 16-year-high Bund yield and continued crowding-out pressure from US hyperscaler EUR/GBP deals.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

1. Strait of Hormuz war, month eight

Structural oil-supply risk with tanker/insurance costs at extremes; Saudi export surge is currently offsetting the disruption, but that could reverse.

2. Fed tightening cycle continuation

Dot plot points to further hikes into year-end 2026; the path now depends heavily on the next several jobs and inflation prints.

3. ECB's inflation-vs-growth balancing act

Deposit rate now 2.50% with energy costs still climbing (European gas +100% since late June); further hikes are live risk for European duration.

4. AI-capex debt wave and crowding-out

Hyperscalers' growing euro/sterling issuance (~€40bn outstanding across five names) is now an explicit ECB concern for European corporate funding costs.

5. European defense re-armament

Record order backlogs (Rheinmetall €80.4bn) and a possible move toward 3%-of-GDP NATO spending targets underpin a multi-year sector re-rating.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY

Hormuz headline risk: Trump's rejection of Iran's offer is the single biggest swing factor for Monday's oil-sensitive names (energy, shipping, airlines) as futures begin trading.

China/Korea reopening: First trading session after Friday's holiday closures — watch for a catch-up gap in either direction feeding into the European open.

Yield direction: Any early move in the 10-year UST (5.17%) or Bund (~3.58%) will set the tone for risk appetite at the European open.

1 WEEK

US Non-Farm Payrolls, Friday: The week's single most important data point for the Fed's next move after a hawkish September hike.

Eurozone flash HICP: A print at or above 3.5% YoY would be the highest since September 2023 and could push the ECB toward further tightening.

Nike / Micron / Accenture earnings, Tuesday: Reads on US consumer resilience, AI-driven memory-chip demand, and enterprise IT spend deceleration.

1 MONTH

Hormuz war duration: Now in its eighth month with no resolution in sight; tanker/insurance cost extremes are a persistent inflation and margin risk across energy-consuming sectors.

Fed and ECB tightening paths: Both central banks hiked in the same week (16 September); further moves from either would be a major cross-asset catalyst into Q4.

AI capex debt and European credit crowding-out: The scale of US hyperscaler EUR/GBP issuance is now large enough that the ECB itself is flagging spread-widening risk for European corporates.

SOURCES USED

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- Bloomberg / Yahoo Finance — Airline stocks and oil price impact
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- GlobalCapital / Marketscreener — European credit market and MPS covered bond pricing
- LSEG / Macrostream — iTraxx/CDX September roll fair-value estimates
- LiteFinance / Newsquawk / Trading Economics — Week-ahead economic calendar Sept 28–Oct 2 2026
- Seeking Alpha / MarketBeat / TradingKey — Nike, Micron, Accenture earnings previews

Data collected automatically via open web sources during this session on 27 September 2026 (a Sunday; markets were closed). The most recent confirmed close for most instruments is Friday 25 September 2026. Fields marked n/a could not be reliably sourced this session and would require Bloomberg Terminal, Refinitiv Eikon or ICE access to confirm. Verify all figures before making any investment or trading decision. This document is not investment advice.